

The Tousignant–Barnes Family: A Narrative

*A presentation layer over research-dossier .md. Regenerated 2026-07-09 (session 20) to fold in the deep-pushback waves of sessions 17–19. Newly woven in: the **Barré line traced to its French immigrant root** — Louis Jean Baré, recorded in his 1722 Chambly marriage as "français de l'évêché de Beauvais," a man of the **diocese of Beauvais** in Picardy — with the Besset and Larocque marriages behind it; the **Monty wall broken** back to Jean Monty and Marie-Marthe Payet, by way of Gaspard Monty's 1737 Chambly baptism (the commandant of Fort Chambly at the font); **Hector Tousignant's death** recovered at last (Christmas Day 1935, his wife Joséphine Lord outliving him), and Joséphine's parents Éloi Lord and Esther Lemay confirmed from the 1889 marriage act; on the English side, **Jane Stamper's father Isaac Stamper** named and the Stamper line pushed back to Isaac Sr and Mary Waterson; and the **Charlebois "two-Damase" puzzle resolved** — Joel and Stephen's Damase proven the son of François-Xavier Charlebois and Olive Quesnel. Builds on the session-16 pushback-and-colour wave (Heffernan to the immigrant Patrick; the Barnes grocer-aunts and Maryhill railway years; the Buckerfield Muskoka childhood). **Session 21 adds the Henschman line on the paternal Buckerfield side — traced and sourced, generation by generation, back to Humphrey Henschman, Bishop of London (1592–1675): the long-held family lore, now confirmed.** Session 31 enriches the recent paternal generations: Peggy Buckerfield identified as **Margaret "Maggie" Maxey** of an English-rooted Paisley-then-London family (emigrating to Calgary in 1920); Frank and Peggy's 1925 Calgary marriage and their retirement and deaths on the British Columbia coast; the exact deaths of Robert and Jane Barnes; and **William Douglas the West Lothian shale miner**, Jane Weir Douglas's father. Supersedes tousignant-barnes-narrative_2026-07-09_0953.md (session 16). **Session 28 (10 Jul 2026)** pushes the Colley line one generation further — William Colley to his parents Joseph Colley and Anne Cottrill (m. 1719, Aston), a new surname **Cottrill** — and records Mary Mason's origins as an unresolved wall.*

Joel and Stephen Tousignant-Barnes descend from two very different streams that each ran for generations before meeting on the Alberta prairie. On their **mother's** side are four French-Canadian and Irish families — Tousignant, Tétrault, Heffernan, Charlebois — whose roots reach back to the founding of New France. On their **father's** side are two British families — the **Barnes** of Scotland and the **Buckerfield**, whose deep root is in Wiltshire but who reached Alberta by way of Wales, the Maritimes, and Ontario. This is the story of both.

The mother's side: out of New France

In the space of thirty-five years in the mid-to-late 1600s, three young men from western France crossed to New France. Louis Tétréau, baptized at Tessonnière in Poitou in 1631, came as an indentured servant of the Jesuits — and promptly got himself hauled into court by them in 1661 for quitting his three-year contract early; once free of it, he leased a hundred arpents, married the widow Noëlle Landeau at Trois-Rivières in 1663, and became a habitant of the Champlain shore. Pierre Tousignant, a soldier of the Compagnie de Montcalm from Blaye in Gironde, reached the colony in 1665 by way of a warship and the Caribbean, and in 1668 married a Fille du Roi at Québec: his bride, Marie-Madeleine Philippe of Paris, had stepped off *La Nouvelle-France* on the third of July, one of some eighty king's daughters landed that day. And Jean-Charles Charlebois, another Gironde man and a soldier of the colonial marine, married at Montréal in 1686 and farmed at Pointe-Claire until 1732, when he sold everything to his son in exchange for care until death — a bargain this family would keep renewing for two hundred and fifty years. Every Tousignant, Tétréault, and Charlebois in North America descends from those three marriages, and the

male lines can now be traced link by dated link, marriage act by marriage act, from each founder down to the great-great-grandparents of the 1880s.

Those roots are not just deep but storied. Through the Tétrault line, Joel and Stephen are half-first-cousins' descendants of **Madeleine de Verchères**, the fourteen-year-old who held her fort against an Iroquois raid in 1692 — her father and their ancestor André Jarret were half-brothers — and one of the men who defended that fort beside her, Pierre Fontaine dit Bienvenu, married into the same family six months before the siege. Through the Charlebois line, by way of the Quesnels, they descend from **Louis Prud'homme**, a settler of Ville-Marie in the 1640s who ran New France's first commercial brewery, and from Prud'homme's father-in-law **Pierre Gadoys**, who took the very first land grant in Montréal in 1648 and was remembered as the town's first farmer. And a plainer marvel sits in the Tousignant line at Saint-Pierre-les-Becquets: Cécile Maillot, a great-grandmother many times over, was the sister of **Modeste Mailhot, "le colosse canadien"** — a strongman whose fame the newspapers confirm, for he was exhibited across Britain in 1829–30 as "the Canadian Giant," billed at 619 pounds and six-foot-four, and his Liverpool notice records that he came "soliciting the honour of being presented to his Majesty" (George IV, as it then was — not the William IV of family legend, who acceded only as Modeste reached London).

For two and a half centuries the Tousignants barely moved, farming that same riverside parish of Saint-Pierre-les-Becquets, where Hector Tousignant was baptized in December 1855 to Joseph Tousignant and Desneiges Charland. Hector married **Joséphine Lord** at Sainte-Sophie-de-Lévrard in 1889 — the act names her the daughter of Éloi Lord and Esther Lemay, with Éloi signing the register — and farmed the home country all his life; he died there on Christmas Day 1935, a *rentier* of eighty, and the burial record calls him "époux de Joséphine," so his wife outlived him. The Tétraults' story turned on a harder arithmetic. In 1881, on Joseph Tétreau and Marie-Rose Tanguay's farm in the Richelieu valley — the couple had married at Marieville in 1859 — the census counted eight children, and Alphonse, marked simply *fils*: a grown son working land that could never be his. Around 1888 a colonizing priest's promise reached parishes exactly like his — 160 acres in Manitoba, a French-Catholic colony, ten dollars to enter — and Alphonse and his wife **Virginie Barré** went. Virginie's own people came from just downriver: her parents, Raphaël Barré and Marguerite Coiteux, had married at L'Ange-Gardien in the Richelieu country in 1857, and the registers have now given up the marriages standing behind that one — and behind those. Raphaël's parents, Charles Barré and Angèle Lanier, had married at Saint-Mathias in 1822; and behind Charles the Barré line now runs back through his own parents, **Louis Barré and Louise Monty** (married at Saint-Mathias in 1780), into the Chambly of the early 1700s — to **Louis Jean Baré**, recorded in his 1722 Chambly marriage as "*français de l'évêché de Beauvais*," a Frenchman of the **diocese of Beauvais** in Picardy, north of Paris. That single line in a parish register is the immigrant root of the whole Barré name, and the point at which its paper trail reaches back across the ocean; his bride, Marie-Josèphe Besset, was a daughter of Jean Besset and Magdeleine Frémondon. On Louise Monty's side the trail reaches **Gaspard Monty**, baptized at Chambly in 1737 with the King's own commandant of Fort Chambly, Gaspard-Joseph Adhémar de Lantagnac, standing as his godfather and namesake — and, through that baptism, back to Gaspard's parents Jean Monty and Marie-Marthe Payet.

Marguerite Coiteux's line held a small human surprise of its own. Her parents had married at Saint-Damase in 1831 — and that entry records a **double wedding**: on the same January day, in the same church, Joseph Coiteux married Charlotte Caouette while his sister married her brother — two Coiteau siblings joined to two Caouette siblings at once (Joseph the son of Joseph Coiteau and Thérèse Chabot, Charlotte the daughter of Simon Caouette and Anastasie Benoit) — and not one of the couples, nor a single witness, could sign the register. That last detail sits oddly beside the honorific the same Joseph Coiteux would carry a generation later, "**Capitaine, Écuyer**," in his daughter's 1857 marriage act: an illiterate farmer of 1831, remembered afterward as a militia captain and esquire, and named among the first land-grantees of L'Ange-Gardien. Alphonse and Virginie's daughter Marie Anne was born in the homestead house at Grande-Clairière in March 1891; in December 1892 Alphonse received his patent, issued in the name of Lord Stanley in the very year he donated his Cup. Then he gave it up. Manitoba had just stripped French Catholics of their schools, and rather than raise children under that law, Alphonse sold his hard-won quarter and went home — to his own father's parish — until the same arithmetic caught the next generation and the family went west a second time, to a French settlement on the Saskatchewan border seeded by the same priest's network. Some families cross a continent once. The Tétraults did it three times.

Meanwhile the old story was recruiting its next man. In 1911 Thomas Tousignant was seventeen, a cultivateur on his father Hector's farm — fifty-two weeks a year, sixty hours a week — the third of three grown sons on land that could pass to only one. Sometime after that page was written he boarded a train west, and in the border district around Dumas found a French parish, work, and the Tétraults' daughter. He and Marie Anne married around 1917; two little girls were registered at Dumas, one named for both her grandmothers at once. Around 1920 the young family pushed to the last free land in the country — the Peace River country — and took a homestead in the bush forty miles beyond Grande Prairie. Their only son, Alphonse, was born in 1921, and the 1926 census catches the household at its most tender: five children under nine, and at the table old Alphonse Tétrault, widowed, come north to live out his years beside the five-year-old grandson who carried his name. Thomas patented his quarter in 1927 — the family's second patent, thirty-five years after his father-in-law's — then moved everyone to town, where he worked his horses as Grande Prairie's freight-hauler and town scavenger through the Depression: eight people in a three-room house on 3rd Avenue South. He and Marie Anne stayed for life.

The Irish and Franco-Ontarian half of the mother's side was assembling itself three hundred miles south, and its deepest Canadian generation has now come clear on the census page. In May 1825, **Patrick Heffernan** and his wife **Margaret Doherty** — he from around Mitchelstown in County Cork, she from Ballyporeen just over the Tipperary line — sailed from Cork Harbour aboard the *Regulus* under Captain George Dixon, two of the poor north-Cork Catholics carried to the Peterborough bush in the government-assisted Peter Robinson emigration. A son, Michael, was born somewhere on the inland leg of the journey; a small daughter died soon after they landed. They took up a lot in **Otonabee Township**, and there the 1851 census finally catches the whole household on a single page: Patrick a farmer of fifty-seven, born in Ireland (so about 1794), his wife fifty-three, and six Canada-West-born sons under the roof — James, John, **Lawrence**, Patrick, Thomas and William — with a married eldest son, Michael,

farming next door. For years the family had hidden from every index under mangled spellings — Hiffernan, Heffman, Heffornan, Hefferon — and it was that run of errors, not any real gap, that had kept the grandfather generation out of reach. That the oldest of the Canada-born sons had arrived by 1832 puts the family in Otonabee by about 1831 — a pre-Famine Irish-Catholic settler household squarely on the north-Cork Peter Robinson profile. It was their Ontario-born son **Lawrence Heffernan** who, on the third of September 1860, married **Bridget Ryan** at the little parish of Our Lady of Mount Carmel in Asphodel. The censuses of 1871 and 1881 fill their farmhouse in — a growing row of children at Asphodel, Peterborough East — and hide a quiet confirmation in the naming: Lawrence and Bridget's two eldest sons are **Patrick** and **Michael**, exactly the two grandfathers the 1860 marriage record names, Patrick Heffernan and Michael Ryan. Bridget herself had been born in Ireland about 1844, and the register records her birthplace only as "Ireland." Which county the Ryans left is still the last locked door on this line; what is clear is only where they did *not* come in — Michael Ryan was no Peter Robinson settler, so the family arrived later, most likely a Famine-era immigrant of the late 1840s or 1850s, into a Peterborough Irish community drawn overwhelmingly from north Cork. Lawrence and Bridget's son Joseph, born in 1879 with a houseful of older siblings between him and the farm, did what surplus sons do: he left — first, remarkably, to Cleveland, where a nineteen-year-old Joseph Heffernan clerked on Payne Avenue and petitioned to become an American in 1903 — before turning back for the one thing America wasn't offering: land. By 1917 he was farming near Grainger, Alberta. And the woman he married there had made the same journey in French.

Eva May Charlebois's people had paused a generation in Finch Township, Ontario — a knot of Charlebois cousins near Crysler — before her father took the family west. Two Charlebois brothers of that settlement, François-Xavier and Pierre, had married two sisters, Olive and Odile Quesnel, and each fathered a son named **Damase** — a coincidence that tangled the record for years. Eva's father was **Damase Xavier Charlebois**, born in 1867 the son of **François-Xavier ("FX") Charlebois and Olive Quesnel**: his 1894 marriage registration at Crysler names those parents outright, the 1901 census seats him in FX's household, and the death dates finally part the cousins — Eva's father lived to 1946 at Carbon, while Pierre and Odile's son died in 1936 in the Timiskaming country. Eva herself was born in October 1892 under her grandparents' roof, the child of Damase's first wife, Odille Rochon, who died the following year; the stepmother who raised the family was **Léonie Aubé** (daughter of Théophile Aubé and Louise Racine), whom Damase married at Crysler in 1894. The family went west earlier than long thought: Damase filed his homestead on **17 July 1903** — the south-west quarter of Section 24, Township 29, Range 23, at **Carbon, in Kneehill County, Alberta** — and the next summer his father FX took the adjacent quarter of the same section, so father and son broke the prairie side by side. FX did not merely see them off; he came west too, and **died on his Carbon homestead on 14 January 1911** (not, as once recorded, back in Ontario). Damase's name was mangled in every prairie census (Domas, Damoss, and, repeatedly, "Thomas") as the family settled onto the grain frontier. Eva was working as a saleslady at a dry-goods counter when she married the Irish farmer from the next township. Their farm prospered: seven rooms, a hired man, and a radio, in the same census month the Tousignants had three rooms and none.

So when Joseph and Eva's daughter **Eileen Heffernan** married Thomas and Marie Anne's son **Alphonse Tousignant** at St. Mary's church in Beiseker in October 1946, it braided the whole mother's side into one: three French migrations and one Irish, running three centuries on the same engine — too many children for the land behind them, a church community waiting ahead. Both bride and groom had been raised by francophone mothers. They settled in Calgary; Alphonse rests at Queen's Park, Eileen's parents at St. Mary's.

The father's side: out of Britain

Joel and Stephen's father's people came far more recently, and by sea. The father, John William Barnes, had been born on the first of April 1869 at **Thorntwaite**, in the English Lake District county of Cumberland — the year his young mother, Jane Stamper, died at twenty-four. That the boy had a family to fall back on at all traces to Jane's own parents. Her father was **Isaac Stamper**, christened at Newlands-by-Keswick in 1789 — himself the son of an elder Isaac Stamper and Mary Waterson — who married **Mary Bowe** of Thorntwaite at Embleton in 1834; the 1841 census of Dean catches their young household whole before Isaac died in the 1840s. Widowed, Mary appears in the 1851 census as "**Mary Stamper, Shop Keeper**" at **Braithwaite**, about forty-seven, with three young daughters at home — Sarah, Mary, and Jane, John William's mother-to-be. The shop is the key to everything that followed. Left a newborn without a mother in 1869, John William was taken in and raised by Jane's sisters — the same Sarah and Mary Stamper, now grown into the **grocers of Braithwaite** who had inherited their widowed mother's trade: the 1871 census finds him at two years old in their household, and ten years on he was still with the aunt Sarah, by then married to a farmer, John Fletcher, on their Cumberland farm. (A tempting lead — a lead-miner named Dixon Barnes enumerated nearby — was tested and set aside: the census shows him the son of a hand-loom weaver with no brother John, so the Barnes patriline still waits on the 1867 Cocker mouth marriage register.) John William married a Scots woman, Mary Nimmo Douglas, at Ecclesmachan in West Lothian in 1892, and by 1901 the couple were living at **2 Campbell Street in Maryhill**, a hard industrial burgh strung along the Forth and Clyde Canal on the edge of Glasgow, its basins ringed with iron foundries and boatyards; there John William worked as a **railway guard**, four small sons in the house — John, Robert Douglas, Stamper, and the infant William. The printed Glasgow electoral register for 1900–01 sets him down in the same words the census enumerator had scrawled — "John W. Barnes, Railway guard, 2 Campbell street" — and adds a small dignity: he held the vote as a "tenant and occupant," an enfranchised working man in a Maryhill railway-workers' tenement among the engine drivers and signalmen of the Glasgow lines. In the spring of **1904** the whole household — the parents and five small sons — sailed from Scotland aboard the Allan Line steamer **SS Corinthian** and landed at **Halifax on the twenty-ninth of April**; the ship's manifest lists them in a single block — John, thirty-five; Mary, forty-two; and the boys John, Robert, Stamper, William and Charles — bound for Fort Macleod. There they went straight onto the land: John William filed his homestead on **17 May 1904 — barely three weeks after stepping off the ship** — on the north-west quarter of Section 6, Township 11, Range 24, in the Little Bow country of southern Alberta, at a railway stop then so new it was still called "Leavings" (it would become Granum, Latin for grain, three years later). The 1904 gamble held: by the 1921 census John William and Mary owned that very quarter, a five-room farmhouse

on it, only the two youngest boys still at home. They lived out their lives on the southern-Alberta prairie and both died at Claresholm — Mary in 1939, John William in 1943, a widower of four years. A grandson's name preserves the mother's family sorrow: one of the boys was called **Stamper**, after the grandmother who had died the year her son was born.

One of those five boys was **Robert Douglas Barnes**, eight years old at the crossing. Grown, he enlisted in the Canadian Field Artillery — Gunner Robert Douglas Barnes, regimental number 331802, of the 61st Field Battery — and on the sixth of September 1917, near Lens, he became the first man in his battery wounded in action, and was carried back to England. He survived, came home, and moved north to farm at **Carbon**, in Kneehill County, where he lived out his life, dying at Calgary on 23 April 1960. He married **Jean Weir Douglas** — a shale-miner's daughter from Kirkliston, in the West Lothian oil-shale country, and, in a small-world turn the records only lately gave up, his own first cousin, the daughter of his mother's brother — who outlived him by twenty years, dying at Carbon on 15 January 1980. Their son, born in 1923, was **John "Jack" Douglas Barnes**, Joel and Stephen's grandfather. That move to Carbon mattered more than Robert can have known: it set the Barnes family down in the very county where the Buckerfields were farming, a few miles off — which is how, a generation on, his son Jack would come to marry a Buckerfield daughter.

The **Buckerfields** carry a Wiltshire surname — the deep root is at Tockenham and Marlborough — but the family reached Alberta by a long detour. The earliest Buckerfield now firmly documented is **Bartholomew Buckerfield, a currier** (leather-dresser) of Marlborough St Peter & St Paul, who married **Elisabeth Brome** of Tockenham, by licence, on 23 August 1764; their son Bartholomew, baptized at Marlborough in 1766, married Elizabeth Jane Henchman in 1794. Bartholomew the currier's own **Prerogative Court of Canterbury will**, proved in London on 8 October 1777, has now been read: styling himself "Bartholomew Buckerfield of Marlborough, currier," he left his whole estate in trust to a Marlborough surgeon for the upbringing of his only son, Bartholomew — confirming, from the primary record, the father-and-son link to the ancestral line — and a legacy "to the sister of my late wife Elisabeth" shows that Elisabeth Brome had by then died. The will is also a family roll-call, remembering a late brother Edward and a widowed sister, Elizabeth Carter. Those very siblings pin his origin: he is the Bartholomew Buckerfield baptized on 16 June 1707 at **Ogbourne St George**, son of **Henry Buckerfield and Elizabeth**, in whose register a brother Edward and a sister Elizabeth were baptized to the same couple; his 1707–1777 memorial and Ogbourne burial close the loop (a Marlborough currier laid to rest in his native downland village seven miles off). The one strain — that b.1707 makes him nearly sixty at his son's 1766 birth — is eased by the will's portrait of an old man who had married late. Elisabeth Brome's own baptism is still untraced: the indexed Wiltshire registers hold only a single Brome christening at Tockenham — Ralph Brome in 1722 — so no Elisabeth was baptized in her marriage parish, and the idea that a "John Brome of Tockenham" was her father is not borne out; the one right-age "Bety" Brome, baptized 1739 at neighbouring Yatton Keynell, was a daughter of Samuel Brome of that parish, not obviously ours. The immigrant ancestor, **William Henry Buckerfield**, was born on 22 March 1836 in England and christened across the water in Glamorgan, **Wales**; he crossed to the Maritimes as a boy in 1846, married a first wife in New Brunswick, and after her death married the Birmingham-born

Mary Ann Dowler — who had herself come out to Canada in 1873 — settling at last in the Muskoka bush of Ontario. Mary Ann's own people were a **Birmingham** brass family, and the trade ran deeper than one generation. Her father **George Dowler** was born in Birmingham on 5 August 1824 and baptized at St Martin in the Bull Ring, the youngest of the ten children of **Joseph Dowler — himself a brass founder, of Moseley Street — and his wife Hannah Ludbury**, who had married at that same church in 1802. Joseph in turn was the son of **Thomas Dowler and Mary Colley**, married "both of this parish" at St Martin in the Bull Ring in 1775 — the couple whose daughter Ann Robbins Dowler appears as George's "aunt" in the 1861 census, and whose surname Colley is a recent addition to this line. Mary was the Mary Colley baptized in that same parish in 1754, a daughter of **William Colley and Mary Mason**, who had married at St Philip's, Birmingham, in 1750 — **Mason** a surname reached by reconstructing the whole Colley household (Sarah, Elizabeth, Mary and William, baptized across the two central parishes). William Colley himself can be followed one generation further: he was, in all likelihood, the William Colley baptized at St Martin in the Bull Ring on 3 October 1721 — the only William Colley christened anywhere in Birmingham in that whole period, and in the very parish where his own children would be baptized — a son of **Joseph Colley**, who had married **Anne Cottrill** at Aston, just outside the town, in October 1719. **Cottrill** thus becomes the newest surname on the tree, and Joseph and Anne's little family (William in 1721, John in 1726, Mary in 1728) sits neatly in the parishes the line already occupied; the link is taken as reported rather than proven, since the St Martin register names only the father. Mary Mason's own origins, by contrast, run into a wall: no Mary Mason was christened in Birmingham in the decades before her marriage, and the 1750 register — a plain list entry — records neither her age nor her parish, so where she came from stays, for now, unknown. Thomas Dowler's own parents are narrowed but not yet proven: the weight of evidence — a second son named Joseph, no son John, another of the family's sons baptized at St Martin, and a metal-trade household whose firm carried on as "Mary Dowler & Son" — points to **Joseph Dowler and Hannah Hallum** of Birmingham St Philip rather than to a rival Sheldon farming family, though the parish registers stop short of naming a grandfather outright. George followed his father into the metal, married **Charlotte** at Aston-juxta-Birmingham in 1850, and by the 1861 census, at Highfield House in Knowle, had become a substantial manufacturer "employing 130 men." Charlotte's maiden name, long thought lost to the record, is settled at last by the imaged Aston marriage register: she was herself a **Dowler**, the daughter of **William Calley Dowler, another Birmingham brass founder** — and the two families prove to be one. William, baptized at St Martin in the Bull Ring in 1782, was a son of the very same Thomas Dowler and Mary Colley, and thus a younger brother of George's father Joseph; his own **1825 Prerogative Court of Canterbury will**, styling him a "brass and bell founder," names his wife Mary, his three children Caroline, Charlotte and William, and his brother Thomas as executor. **George and Charlotte, in other words, were first cousins** — both grandchildren of Thomas Dowler and Mary Colley — and Charlotte's mother was **Mary Harper**, whom William had married at Aston in 1821. The 1891 and 1901 censuses now catch that Muskoka household on the page: William Henry a farmer in his fifties, Mary Anne, and their young children — among them **George Francis "Frank" Buckerfield**, whose birth the 1901 return pins exactly to **2 March 1884**, confirming he was **Ontario-born**, not an English immigrant at all. A telling figure sits in the 1891 household beside the young family: an older daughter, Mary E., twenty-four and New-Brunswick-born

— a child of William Henry's first wife, living on with her father's second family, and physical corroboration of the New Brunswick first-marriage chapter that had otherwise been known only from an index. Frank came west and by the 1920s was farming near **Three Hills**, a wheat town on the Grand Trunk Pacific line a few miles from Carbon that had just acquired, in 1922, the Bible institute that would make it famous. In 1925, at Calgary, he married **Margaret "Maggie" Maxey** — "Peggy" — born at Paisley in 1886, though only half a Scot: her father, **James Maxey**, was an Englishman from Corby in Lincolnshire, and it was his wife **Sarah Macdonald** who gave the line its Scottish (and its granddaughter's middle) name. The Maxeys had drifted from a Lincolnshire village to the Renfrewshire thread town of Paisley and on to London; it was from there that Peggy emigrated alone in 1920, crossing to Quebec aboard the SS *Saturnia* with "Calgary" written against her name. Frank and Peggy farmed near Three Hills and later at Red Deer, then retired, late in life, to the British Columbia coast at **Cloverdale** — where Peggy died at Surrey in 1963 and Frank in 1976. Two years after their marriage, in 1927, they had a daughter, **Margaret Macdonald Buckerfield**, who carried her Scottish grandmother's maiden name in her own. She grew up on the farm and, at eighteen, became a country schoolteacher — grades one through nine in the one-room Lumni School, then Swallow. On 19 February 1949, at Cloverdale — where her parents had by then retired — she married Jack Barnes, and the couple settled on his family's Carbon farm; their firstborn, an infant son named Ian, died in 1950. Margaret outlived Jack, married again in 1983 (which is why her later years were spent as Margaret Hugo), volunteered tirelessly, and — at sixty-one — danced in the opening ceremony of the 1988 Calgary Olympics. She died in Calgary in 2022, aged ninety-five.

There is more to the Buckerfield story than the surname. Twice — in 1794 and again in 1824 — a Buckerfield man married a **Henchman** woman, and the two brides turn out to have been half-sisters, both daughters of **Francis Henchman**, baptized at Huntingdon in 1741. (William Henry Buckerfield's 1824 bride, Sarah, was the half-sister of his own mother, Elizabeth Jane — so he married his half-aunt, and the same Henchman blood entered the family a second time.) The family had long carried — and worked on — the knowledge that it descended from **Humphrey Henchman, Bishop of London**: this was no unproven myth, but a link Joel and Stephen's grandmother Margaret ("Nana"), a genealogist of her own family, had herself traced and known. The records, followed back one generation at a time, confirm and firm up what she had already followed home. Francis's father was the **Rev. Francis Henchman, Rector of Ruan Lanihorne in Cornwall**, entered in the Oxford matriculation register of 1729 as "son of Thomas, of the Close of Salisbury, clerk." That Thomas was the **Rev. Thomas Henchman, Prebendary of Salisbury** (1666–1746), whose memorial in the cathedral still calls him "nephew of Humphrey, Bishop"; and his own father, another Thomas, had been baptized in Salisbury Cathedral in 1630 as the eldest surviving son of the Bishop himself. The proof runs in the property as well as the parish books: the Manors of Milford and Woodford, just outside Salisbury, which the Bishop willed to his son Thomas in 1675, descend through the very wills that name each following generation. So the descent Margaret had followed holds, vindicated in the record. **Humphrey Henchman (1592–1675)** — canon of Salisbury, the Royalist who helped the future Charles II escape after the Battle of Worcester, Bishop of Salisbury and then of London through the Great Plague and the Great Fire, Privy Councillor and Fellow of the Royal Society — stands at the head of this line: roughly Joel and Stephen's

ninth-great-grandfather, reached through Elizabeth Jane Henschman and the Buckerfields.

Where the two streams meet

Here is the quiet coincidence at the heart of it. Before ever a Tousignant met a Barnes, both sides of the family had already gathered in the same small corner of Alberta: the **Charlebois** on their mother's side homesteading at Carbon in 1903, and the **Barnes** and, nearby, the **Buckerfields** on their father's side farming Carbon and Three Hills in the same years — neighbours, effectively, a generation and more before anyone thought to marry. In time a child of the French-Canadian and Irish line and a child of the Scottish and English line did marry, and their sons are Joel (born 1988) and Stephen (born 1991). That intervening generation is living, and is kept private here; the record closes with the two brothers.

The whole of it runs like this: from Beauvais and Poitou and Gironde to Québec, out to Manitoba and back, then to Saskatchewan and the Peace; from County Cork to the Peterborough bush and on through Cleveland to Grainger; from Cumberland and Glasgow across the Corinthian's deck to Halifax, Granum and Carbon; from Wiltshire by way of Wales and Muskoka to Three Hills — and, at the last, all of it to Calgary, where the family has now been for eighty years.